ART ▼

IAF's Boldest Edition

WITH 133 EXHIBITORS, AMBITIOUS PERFORMANCE COMMISSIONS AND CITY-WIDE PROGRAMMING, **INDIA ART FAIR**'S UPCOMING EDITION MARKS A DECISIVE CULTURAL EXPANSION





CRAFT, REIMAGINED Clockwise from above, Dhruv Agarwwal's 'Bloom' (2020) chandelier created with Channapatna toys; Benjamin Baccarani's 'Castle'; Andreas Eriksson's 'The Quarry' (2024-2025)

In what is being touted as its most ambitious outing yet, India Art Fair (IAF) returns for its 17th edition from February 5 to 8 at the NSIC Exhibition Grounds, New Delhi, with presenting partner BMW India. "It represents a maturing moment for the fair," says fair director Jaya Asokan. This year, the event will host a record 133-plus exhibitors, including 94 galleries and leading international and regional institutions, marking its largest presentation yet.

Positioning itself as the definitive destination for discovering modern and contemporary art from South Asia, IAF this year expands both its curatorial scope and public engagement. This year's edition also features 26 new exhibitors, translating into a comprehensive slate of outdoor art projects, performance commissions, talks, institutional collaborations, learning initiatives, and city-wide activations.

"Several artists are unveiling new works created specifically for the fair, affirming its role as a catalyst for artistic experimentation," says Asokan. In that vein, IAF's landmark 'The Future Is Born of Art' Commission, marking a decade of partnership with BMW India, is moving to a bold new format to be displayed across the fair's façade, with the commission being awarded to Afrah Shafiq. Her work involves embroidery, memory, labour and women's histories through large-scale public installation and interactive AR layers. This, in addition to the debut performance art collaboration with HH Art Spaces, supported by Soho House and curated by Nikhil Chopra, featuring Yuko Kaseki, Uriel Barthélémi and Suman Sridhar/Black Mamba, with live sonic and movement-based works.

The JSW-supported Talks Programme is set to interrogate artistic conditions in South Asia and globally. Also, the OPEN Design Talks, curated by Border & Fall, spotlight design practices in South Asia and worldwide.

A host of outdoor art projects and major parallel programmes extend the fair's reach with exhibitions at the KNMA, the National Gallery of Modern Art, and the first-ever solo exhibition in India by Ai Weiwei, presented by Nature Morte. ■

–Arshia

From Feb. 5-8 at NSIC Exhibition Grounds, Delhi

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